

Bigger than Amanda.

Aspie supremacy, elite capture, and what happened when an autistic creator said so out loud.

by Ryan Perez → @digitalstemcell

I'm Ryan. I'm one of us.

Autistic. Dyslexic. ADHD. I build digital systems and make content about neurodivergent life as **Digital Stem Cell**.

This is not a takedown. Read the next slide — I was **defending** Amanda Seales when this started.

Everything quoted here is from public live streams and interviews, transcribed verbatim. Punctuation added for readability.

— WHAT HAPPENED

- 01 When the internet piled on Amanda over the Issa Rae discourse, I made a video **defending her**.
- 02 In a comment, I said the one thing I couldn't co-sign: **"I don't like the way that she represents autism because it's giving Aspie supremacy — but it doesn't negate the fact that she don't deserve to be safe, no matter what she does."**
- 03 She blocked me.

Critique plus care. That was the whole comment.

"He was supportive, and then I saw him under a post saying that he didn't like my brand of autism. Because he says he feels that I speak about autism from an autism supremacist point of view. So he was blocked. That's how that happened."

— Amanda Seales, live stream, July 2026

The "he" is me.

Intra-community ableism is not a representation problem.

It's a formal operation — and it runs the same way every time, no matter whose face is on it.

Import metrics that were never diagnostic criteria:

intelligence · innovation · productivity

Those metrics are the **constitutive axes of ableism itself**. So importing them doesn't add attributes to the category —

it installs an internal **ranking axis**. Importation and othering are one event, happening at the same time.

"I'm good at so much that there was no question that I'm autistic. You can't be good at that many things and not be autistic... If there was any proof that I was autistic, it was that I got mad talents, B."

— Amanda Seales, live stream

Talent offered as the diagnostic proof. **Talent is not a criterion.** The moment it verifies membership, the category has been re-ranked around it.

"That is what neurotypical mindsets are. They are controlled... it's like clones. We are on a planet comprised of drones and individuals."

— Amanda Seales, live stream

Once the axis is installed, an out-group is required. Here it's every neurotypical person on earth — recast as **drones**.

"I have a brain that is wired a particular way that makes it difficult to indoctrinate."

"The supertism. That's right."

"I attract a much higher IQ these days."

— Amanda Seales, live streams

Immunity. Superiority. IQ. The ranking metrics are her own capital.

Hierarchy of impairment

Disabled people ranking other disabled people — Deal, 2003

Aspie supremacy

"High-functioning" autism framed as superiority — de Hooze, 2019

Neurodiversity-lite

Celebrating only the marketable autistic traits — Dwyer et al., 2025

**The surface has been documented for twenty years.
The shared mechanism hasn't.**

Elite capture.

Táiwò (2022): the most advantaged members of a group capture its public goods and speak in its name.

Applied here, the public good being captured is **the diagnostic category itself** — who autism belongs to, and what it gets to mean.

— WHY AUTISM IS CAPTURABLE

Entry verification is socially suspended — **on justice grounds**. And those grounds are real: diagnosis costs thousands, and Black women are chronically misdiagnosed.

"No, I have not been clinically diagnosed by a doctor, because I'm not paying \$10,000 to do that."

— Amanda Seales, live stream

A category no one is allowed to audit is a category anyone with enough capital can capture. The justice suspension is legitimate — **the vulnerability is its side effect.**

"My autism diagnosis is not for you all to discuss. It's not up for your debate. And anyone who is... trying to invalidate diagnosis that comes outside of a clinician is only revealing that they actually don't know anything about autism."

— Amanda Seales, responding to Baller Alert

Look at the shape of that rule: the only people disqualified from asking are the people asking. She enters as a **member** and rules as the **arbiter** — simultaneously.

— THE DIAGNOSTIC SIGNATURE

The support-claim contradiction.

Claim exceptional **capacity** when status is on the table.

Retain the draw of **incapacity** when accountability is.

**"I'm not yelling at you. I speak loud.
That's part of my autism."**



**"And this time I'm not yelling because of
my autism. I'm yelling because you're
annoying."**

— Amanda Seales, live streams

**The accommodation switches on and off — at her
discretion. That is the signature, self-operated.**

"Y'all... hit me with the all caps — **my autism cannot take all that.**"

"'It's not what you say, it's how you say it' — one, **it's ableist**, in that it ignores the fact that many autistic people, myself included, speak in a very direct, didactic way."

"**I take everything literal**... because of my autism I don't typically know if you're being honest or not."

— Amanda Seales, live streams

Real autistic experiences — kept fully claimable. The genius claims run in parallel, never instead.

When the category gets re-ranked, people disappear:

- Non-speaking and high-support-needs autistics — invisible in the genius frame.
- Autistic people whose autism can't be monetized or performed.
- Anyone who critiques from inside — reclassified as ableist, a bot, an op... or blocked.

A captured category protects its most powerful member first.

Amanda isn't the disease. She's a symptom the model predicts.

Any low-audit category plus any high-capital entrant produces the same operation: enter through non-criterial fill, re-rank along your own advantages, rule as member-and-arbiter.

Watch for the signature. Not the celebrity.

"I don't like the way that she represents autism because it's giving Aspie supremacy — but it doesn't negate the fact that she don't deserve to be safe, no matter what she does. Y'all deserve to be safe no matter what."

— me, in the comment that got me blocked

Critique is not attack. Safety and accountability are not opposites. Autistic people deserve both — from the world, and from each other.

If this work matters, fund it.

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